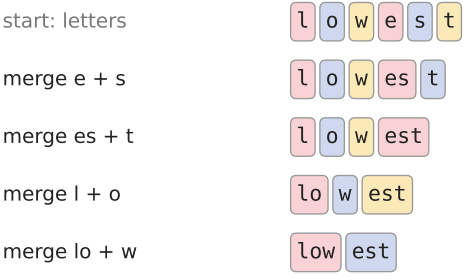
start: letters
l o w e s t
merge e + s
l o w es t
merge es + t
l o w est
merge l + o
lo w est
merge lo + w
low est